Alvaro Contreras Mellado

Department of Economics, Boston University
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EDUCATION

Boston University, Ph.D. in Economics — Expected May 2027
Committee: Marc Rysman (Chair), Jihye Jeon, and Gaurab Aryal

London School of Economics and Political Science, M.Sc. in Economics — 2020
Grade obtained: Distinction

Universidad del Pacífico, M.A. in Economics — 2016

Universidad del Pacífico, B.A. in Economics — 2015

FIELDS AND RESEARCH INTERESTS

Fields: Empirical Industrial Organization, Financial Economics
Research Interests: Banking, Financial Intermediation, Spatial Competition

WORKING PAPERS

Branch Closures and Spatial Competition in Retail Banking
Job Market Paper

Outsourcing and Competition in the Banking Sector: The Rise of Cloud Service Providers
with Peter Eccles and Paolo Siciliani

Countercyclical Capital and Reserve Requirements as Macroprudential Stabilizers
with Diego Bohórquez

WORK IN PROGRESS

Roadside Infrastructure, Spatial Complementarities, and Transportation Efficiency
with Sarah Armitage, Frank Pinter, and Ron Yang

Green Buildings: Aggregate Effects of Housing Carbon Policies
with Olivia Bordeu and Santiago Franco

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Harvard University — Fall 2026
EC10: Principles of Economics

Instructor, Boston University — Summers 2023–24
Summer Challenge: Economics Seminar

Teaching Fellow, Boston University — Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Spring 2024
EC102: Introduction to Macroeconomic Analysis

Teaching Assistant, Universidad del Pacífico Business School — Fall 2018
Advanced Macroeconomics (graduate level)

Teaching Assistant, Universidad del Pacífico — 2014–17
Principles of Economics I, Microeconomics I, Macroeconomics I, Mathematics for Economists III and IV

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026 Columbia University–Bank Policy Institute Research Conference on Bank Regulation
Southern Economic Association Conference *(upcoming)*

2025 Brown University Economics Ph.D. Conference
Latin American Journal of Central Banking (LAJCB) Conference (Mexico City, Mexico)

2023 LACEA-LAMES (Bogotá, Colombia)

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Boston University 2023 – 2026
Santiago Franco (Fall 2024–Spring 2026), Sarah Armitage (Summer 2024), Pascual Restrepo (Fall 2023), Marianne Baxter (Summer 2023)

Ph.D. Research Intern, Bank of England July – October 2025
Research on cloud outsourcing, bank competition, and financial stability

Research Coordinator, Department of Financial Planning and Strategy, Ministry of Economy and Finance of Peru September 2020 – July 2021
Research and quantitative modeling for Treasury asset and liability management

Associate, Senior Analyst and Analyst, Economic Studies, APOYO Consultoría 2015 – 2019
Economic research, forecasting, and sector analysis

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Best Teaching Fellow Award at the Boston University Economics Department 2023

Ph.D. Fellowship, Boston University 2021 – 2026

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee, *Latin American Journal of Central Banking*

WORKSHOPS

Big Data Initiative in International Macro-Finance, Stanford Graduate School of Business 2024

Summer School on Structural Estimation in Corporate Finance, The Wharton School of the University of Pennsylvania 2023

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Technical Skills: R, Python, Stata, Julia, SQL, MATLAB/Dynare, EViews, Excel, Visual Basic
Languages: Spanish (native); English (fluent)
Citizenship / Visa: Peru / F-1

REFERENCES

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Sarah Armitage
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